

Passage/Book

Introduction

A single sentence or two is acceptable.

Author

A single sentence or two is acceptable.

Date of Writing

A single sentence or two is acceptable.

Historical Setting

A single sentence or two is acceptable. Often a paragraph is better. This is what is happening historically on a local, regional, and international setting.

Place of Writing

A single sentence or two is acceptable.

Recipients

A single sentence or two is acceptable. This is particularly important since your interpretation will involve what the first audience (recipients) understood.

Occasion and Purpose

A single sentence or perhaps a paragraph (3 or 4 sentences) is acceptable. This deals with why to book was written. What did the author hope to accomplish with his or her work?

Theme (Message Statement)

This segment is extremely important. The theme (or message statement or big idea or exegetical idea) is the one sentence that summarizes the entire passage. This sentence should include one subject (what the author is talking about) and a compliment (what does the author say about that subject). This will be the exact same thing as the heading of your sentence outline.

Argument

This is extremely important. You need to work your way through the entire passage paragraph by paragraph. Note the relationship between paragraphs. Explain how each paragraph fits within the entire passage. Each pericope, consisting of several paragraphs, needs to be explained properly.

Simple Outline

This is an outline of the entire passage. Be detailed. Please note that this outline needs to harmonize with the argument above and with your book chart. It would be beneficial if you developed this outline on your own.

Sentence Outline

This is an outline of the entire passage. Be detailed. Please note that this outline needs to harmonize with the argument above. Each paragraph must be a complete sentence with a subject and compliment. Furthermore, each pericope and segment (group of pericopes) must be a complete sentence. The sentence for the entire book will be the “theme” as detailed above.

As a result, each paragraph will have a “sentence.” This sentence will become your “main idea,” “exegetical idea,” “big idea,” and so forth.

Book Chart

You will need to produce a “book chart.” Simple ones are found in various places. You may wish to incorporate a grid chart beneath your book chart. That would be helpful. You will need to be specific in your chart. Here you will utilize things you learned so far in your *Inductive Bible Study Method* course.

Presentation is also part of the chart. One purpose of a chart is to convey much material in a simple, visual summary.

Grading: Please note the grade for this Learning Task will come from the above. Note especially (1) the theme, (2) the argument, (3) the simple outline, the (4) sentence outline, and (5) the book chart. Each of these five segments must harmonize with the other four. In other words, the theme cannot disagree with the content of the outline. Likewise, the argument cannot be divergent from the book chart.

Note below the “Writing Helps” on the format this Learning Task should include.

Writing Helps

1. Do not right-hand justify.
2. Always use Spell-check AND Grammar-check. If you do not know how to do this, please contact a classmate or someone on the EAST library staff.
3. Use the past tense when writing about biblical events.
4. Use 1-inch margins.
5. Proofread your own paper. Have others proofread it also. If you need help with English, get it.
6. Always abbreviate biblical citations within parenthesis (1 Chron 11:1) but write out within the paragraph, like First Chronicles 11:1. Make sure you use the correct abbreviations.
7. Use shorter sentences. Do not run on and on and on.
8. Watch your periods, especially after quotations.
RIGHT word.” WRONG word”.
9. Stop. Notice, there is only one space between a period and the beginning of the next sentence.
10. Use what you learned from *Academic Research and Writing* course.
11. Presentation is important.